

Rain and drizzle

Without clouds, it wouldn't rain. Rain is simply water falling from clouds of tiny water droplets. Clouds form because air currents carry air up until it cools, and the water vapor turns into drops of water, which fall as rain. When the raindrops are very fine, they fall as drizzle.

Record rainfall

The wettest place in the world is Mawsynram village in India, where up to 467 in (11,872 mm) of rain falls every year.



Raining ice

Sometimes rain falls as solid chunks of ice, called hailstones. These are made when raindrops are tossed high up in huge clouds, and freeze into ice. As they are bounced up and down inside the cloud, they grow into big hailstones.



See how the ice builds up in layers, like the layers of an onion.